TEN-CHANNEL ELECTROACOUSTIC WORK ~~~ FIXED MEDIA

Whispering Space

WRITTEN FOR & DEDICATED TO
DIAPASON GALLERY · NEW YORK CITY
TEN-SPEAKER ARRAY · MAX/MSP · TOUCHDESIGNER

~ SOUND CONCEPT

The sound system consists of four generative layers — a generative synthesizer, a soundscape of white noise, intermittent noise, and a sound object player — conceived for a ten-speaker array and realized in Max/MSP. During the work's creation, motion sensing in TouchDesigner allowed parameters to be shaped in real time.

~ PROGRAM NOTE

A work written for, and dedicated to, playback on a ten-speaker array at Diapason Gallery in New York City, in response to AI-generated music and how it dehumanizes and deconstructs the process of creation.

Left to themselves, the work's four Max/MSP patches are cyclical — systems that could run without end. For this piece, I intervened: shaping their endless output into a fixed, linear composition with a beginning, a trajectory, and an ending. That intervention is the point. Where AI generation produces without deciding, this work stands as a testament to mindful generative music — generative not by machine learning, but by the human brain's knowledge of mathematics and music theory, its instinctual creativity, and its willingness to choose.

The work also features live-captured construction noise and the sounds of North Vancouver's traffic signals: a reaction toward things that LLMs can never replicate.

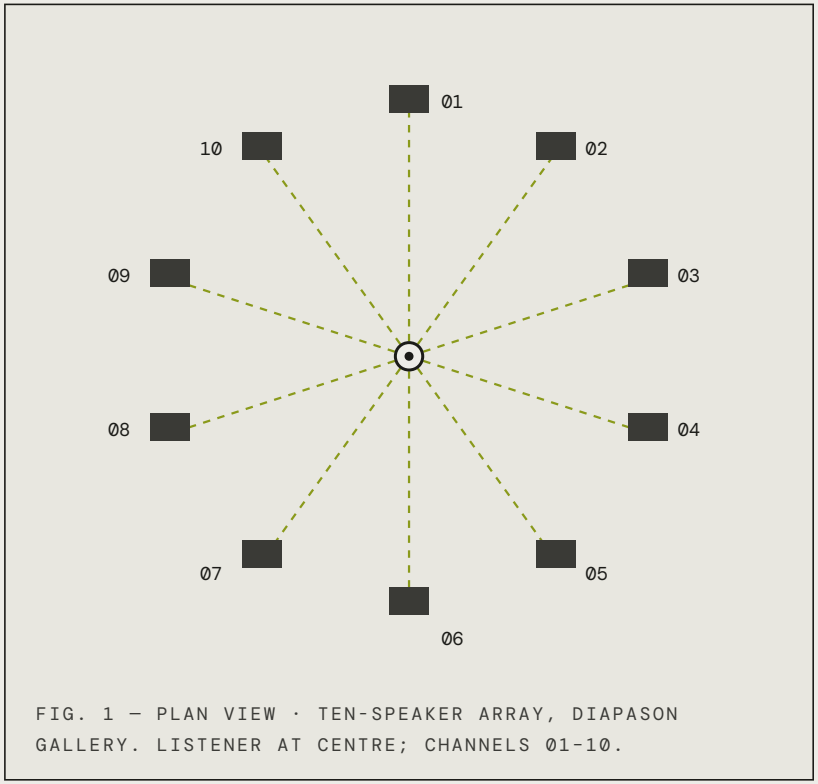
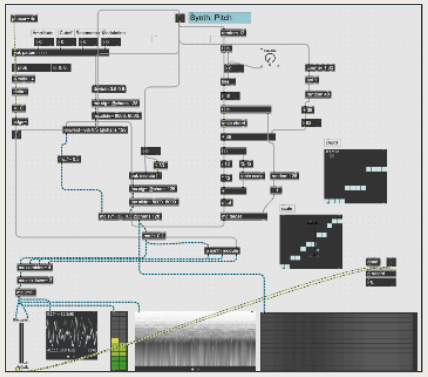


FIG. 1 — PLAN VIEW · TEN-SPEAKER ARRAY, DIAPASON GALLERY. LISTENER AT CENTRE; CHANNELS 01-10.

FORMAT	Fixed media, 10-channel
SYSTEM	Max/MSP · four generative patches
CONTROL	TouchDesigner motion sensing (in creation)
SOURCES	Subtractive synthesis · environmental buffers · foley recordings · construction noise & North Vancouver traffic signals (live-captured)
METHODS	Markov randomization · probabilistic triggering · crossfade & envelope shaping · stretch / pitch-shift / delay

Max/MSP Patches

CYCLICAL SYSTEMS,
SHAPED INTO A **LINEAR WORK**

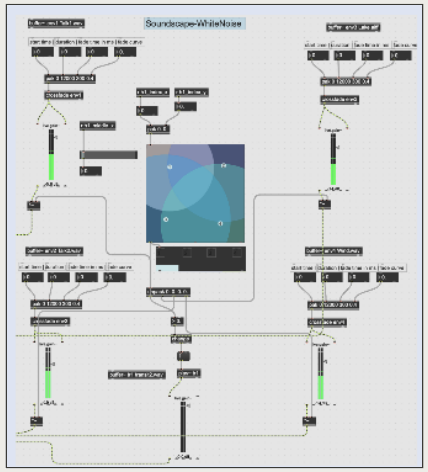


Subtractive synth with pitch, scale & chord controls; outputs visualized with meters and spectral displays.

PATCH 1 · GENERATIVE SYNTHESIZER

This generative synthesizer uses subtractive synthesis to generate sound, acting as a neutral "white canvas" where pitched elements are layered and shaped generatively. Symbolically, it represents the foundation of creativity: a versatile, uncolored base that allows musical ideas to emerge and evolve freely.

`live controls: modulation / filtering / amplitude`

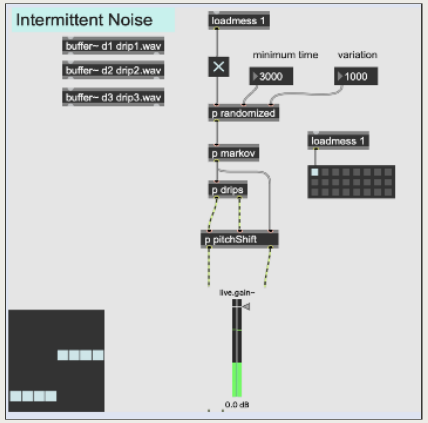


Sliders and numerical inputs, driven by motion detected in TouchDesigner, adjust duration, fade time and start points.

PATCH 2 · AMBIENT SOUNDSCAPE

A generative soundscape of white noise, symbolically representing real-world objects through the dynamic blending of environmental sounds. It interprets the essence of these objects in an abstract auditory form, bringing their presence into focus.

`environmental sound buffers: crossfades / dynamic levels / envelope shaping`

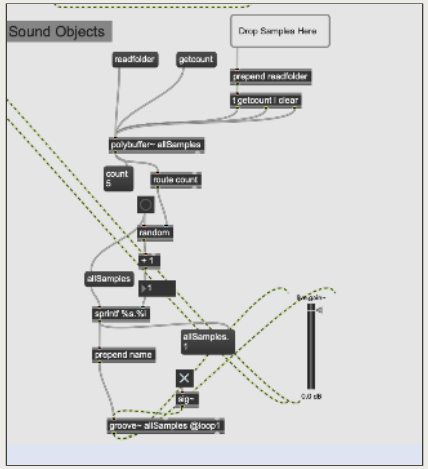


Preset system for recalling states; Markov-based randomization; pitch-shift subpatch modifying signals dynamically.

PATCH 3 · INTERMITTENT NOISE

Intermittent noise appears in irregular bursts rather than continuously, emerging unpredictably with shifting pitch; it represents loneliness and wonder. This third layer adds depth and movement, creating an ethereal, introspective quality that reinforces themes of solitude and curiosity.

`drips subpatch: probabilistic triggering of preloaded buffers`



Random sample selection and playback from polybuffer~ using random, sprintf and groove~.

PATCH 4 · SOUND OBJECT PLAYER

Inspired by *musique concrète*, the sound object player combines multiple layers of intense everyday noises. Foley-recorded sounds are edited using stretch, pitch shifting, delay and echo, following Schaeffer's concept of reduced listening: removed from their original context, the sounds become abstract textures that evoke the overwhelming sensation of daily anxiety and distraction.

`foley sources → stretch / pitch-shift / delay / echo`